



DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC SAFETY GEORGIA STATE PATROL

PURSUIT CRITIQUE

TROOPER NAME – TFC Emilee Shackelford #875

Work Assignment: Troop/Division - A; Post/Unit – 5 - Dalton

INCIDENT REPORT # DPS00170242

Related Crash Reports: C000951250 ; _____ ; _____

P.I.T. Involved: No

S.C.R.T. Involved: No

Special Investigations Unit Involved: No

Use of Force Involved: Yes

MEETING

1. Document the date, time and location of the pursuit critique meeting with the involved trooper.

Date: 6/28/2024

Time: 1040 Hours

Location: Post 5 - Dalton

2. List all personnel present at the meeting by name and rank. Include the trooper, an NCO in whose territory the pursuit was terminated, and the trooper's immediate supervisor.

Personnel present: Lieutenant Tim Nichols #36, SFC Stephen Kennedy #754 and TFC Emilee Shackelford #875

INITIATION

1. Provide the date and time the trooper became involved in the pursuit.

Date: 5/28/2024

Time: 1824 Hours

2. Explain the circumstances that led to the trooper's involvement in the pursuit.

On 5/28/2024, at approximately 1824 hours, a Hamilton County, Tennessee Deputy Sheriff was pursuing a blue Subaru whose driver matched the description of a suspect involved in an aggravated assault. The pursuit had traveled south out of Tennessee and into the City of Ringgold where a Ringgold Police Officer joined in the pursuit. Once in Georgia, Hamilton County Sheriff's Office and the Ringgold Police Department requested the assistance of the Georgia State Patrol. TFC Shackleford intercepted the pursuit on GA 3 just west of I-75. As the pursuit traveled onto I-75 South, TFC Shackleford took over the primary position.

3. If trooper's involvement was the result of a request from another agency, provide details regarding the request.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: A Hamilton County, Tennessee Sheriff's Deputy was in pursuit of a suspect who was wanted for Aggravated Assault. The pursuit had traveled into Georgia and the city of Ringgold where a Ringgold Police Officer joined the pursuit. The Hamilton County Sheriff's Office and the city of Ringgold Police Department had requested the assistance of the Georgia State Patrol.

4. List the number and identity of other agencies and officers involved in the pursuit.

☐ N/A

If needed, list: Along with TFC Shackleford, Hamilton County Deputy Bolen and Ringgold Police Officer Borgdon #410 were also involved in the pursuit.

5. If other occupants were in the patrol vehicle, identify them and state their reason for being in the vehicle.

☒ N/A

If Yes, list:

6. Did the trooper take appropriate safety precautions?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper eliminate distractions such as FM radio noise?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

COMMUNICATION

1. If the reporting trooper initiated the pursuit by means of observing a violation and attempting a traffic stop, explain the communication that took place between the trooper and the CEO.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: Once TFC Shackleford joined the pursuit, she provided her location and direction of travel. Senior Dispatcher A. Jennings received this information and updated the CAD call.

2. Did the trooper relay pertinent information to the CEO including:

- Location and direction of travel.
- Description of the pursued vehicle.
- Number and description of occupants.
- Information regarding the use of firearms, threat of force, or other hazard.
- Options for terminating the pursuit.
- Observed danger to public safety.
- Any need for assistance.

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Explain any communication that took place between the CEO and other law enforcement agencies or officers in the area.

☐ N/A

Explain: Once TFC Shackleford joined the pursuit, Senior Dispatcher A. Jennings cleared the radio for emergency traffic before conducting a broadcast of the pursuit to all Troop A Troopers. Dispatcher Silvers contacted the Catoosa County 911 Center while Dispatcher Cain contacted the Whitfield County 911 Center by telephone to advise them of the pursuit and to request their assistance.

4. If the reporting trooper became involved in the pursuit at the request of another agency, explain any communication that took place between the trooper and another officer of the requesting agency. Give details of communication between the CEO and the requesting agency regarding the location, direction of travel, nature of the offense, any pending warrants, and details of erratic driving behavior illustrating the potential danger to the public if the suspect is not immediately apprehended.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: A Hamilton County, Tennessee Sheriff's Deputy was in pursuit of a suspect who was wanted for Aggravated Assault. The pursuit had traveled into Georgia and the city of Ringgold where a Ringgold Police Officer joined the pursuit. The Hamilton County Sheriff's Office and the city of Ringgold Police Department had requested the assistance of the Georgia State Patrol.

5. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

6. At the conclusion of the pursuit, did the trooper advise the CEO immediately, so other units would be familiar with the location to offer assistance, or slow in an effort to reduce the likelihood of further risk of injury to either a trooper or a member of the general public?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

7. Discuss any needed areas of improvement with the CEO.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

PURSUIT

1. Describe the route the pursuit traveled, its duration and distance.

Describe: The pursuit initiated on I-75 South at GA 3 and traveled southbound until it terminated at mile marker 336 (also GA 3). The pursuit traveled approximately 9 miles and lasted 6 minutes and 26 seconds.

2. Were the trooper's actions during the pursuit objectively reasonable?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. If the pursuit traveled into another post's territory, explain whether the initiating trooper yielded to a trooper whose territory the pursuit was in.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

4. If the initiating trooper yielded the primary position to another unit, explain whether he proceeded to the termination point of the pursuit to provide guidance and information for the arrest of the violator.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

5. Explain if there were any factors during the pursuit that indicated the possible commission of a felony.

☐ N/A

If Yes, explain: The violator's actions during the pursuit support a charge of Felony Fleeing and Attempting to Elude.

6. Did the trooper articulate his observations?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

7. Did the trooper practice commentator driving?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

8. Did the trooper remain calm and professional during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

DRIVING SKILLS

1. Did the trooper use due caution when operating his vehicle during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. Were the driving skills/techniques initiated appropriately?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during the pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

4. Were the driving skills/techniques appropriate during termination?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

5. Did the trooper appear to experience adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or any other internal/external factors?

☒ No

If Yes, explain:

6. Did the trooper get into the danger zone due to adrenalin rush, tunnel vision, or other factors?

☒ No

If Yes, explain:

EQUIPMENT

1. Were the blue lights and siren in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. If the patrol car was equipped with wig-wag headlights, were they in operation during the entire pursuit?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

3. Was the in-car camera working properly?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

4. Was the trooper's microphone working properly?

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

TERMINATION

1. Did the trooper continue the pursuit to a conclusion? If not, explain the reasons.

☒ Yes

☐ No

If no, explain:

2. Was there a good probability of the suspect's arrest at a later time because of positive identification?

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

3. Articulate attempts taken by the trooper to utilize pursuit termination techniques, such as tire deflating devices, roadblocks, P.I.T. maneuver, and trooper discretion.

☐ N/A

Explain: While traveling southbound on I-75, TFC Shackleford attempted to implement a Precision Immobilization Technique near mile marker 339. TFC Shackleford made contact with the right rear of the Subaru and the left front of her patrol vehicle. However, the attempt was unsuccessful and the pursuit continued southbound on I-75.

4. Expound on safety precautions utilized by the trooper during and after the pursuit.

☐ N/A

Explain: TFC Shackleford exercised due caution and utilized all of her emergency equipment throughout the pursuit. TFC Shackleford operated her vehicle in a responsible manner and demonstrated good judgement/decision making skills to not attempt a PIT maneuver in or around other traffic.

5. Articulate the existing traffic conditions during the pursuit, realizing the conditions may differ at various times during the pursuit.

Explain: The pursuit occurred during daytime hours with clear skies and a dry road surface. The traffic along I-75 South at the time of the pursuit would be described and moderate to heavy.

6. Address whether there are any conditions that would create additional danger to the public by continuing the pursuit.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

7. Address whether there were any conditions that necessitated the pursuit being brought to an immediate conclusion and describe the conditions.

☒ N/A

If Yes, explain:

8. Establish whether the violator was an immediate threat to the trooper, the public or themselves.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: The violator fled at speeds in excess of 100 miles per hour, drove in the emergency lanes and improperly passed other vehicles. The violator showed no regard for the safety of himself or others.

9. Outline whether the use of deadly force was justified and if so, why it was justified.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

10. Establish whether the method of termination was reasonable based on the facts gathered during the pursuit, and state those facts.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

11. If there were any injuries, state who received them, the type and severity.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: The violator sustained minor abrasions as a result of falling to the ground after the Taser deployment.

12. If there was a fatality, provide basic facts surrounding the circumstances.

☒ N/A If Yes, explain:

13. Address any damage to vehicles.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: The Subaru and the Dodge sustained minor damage as a result of the PIT attempt.

TROOPER'S ABILITIES AND EXPERIENCE

1. Prior pursuits (compare if appropriate).

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: TFC Shackleford has been involved in numerous pursuits during her career as a Georgia State Trooper.

2. Past use of techniques and high speed driving.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: TFC Shackleford has received E.V.O.C., Advanced E.V.O.C. and Pursuit-Ending Tactics Training.

ISSUES ADDRESSED

1. Positives.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: TFC Shackleford utilized all her emergency equipment, exercised due caution throughout the pursuit and demonstrated good judgement/decision making skills. TFC Shackleford operated her patrol car in a responsible manner while commentating and communicating the violator's actions during the pursuit.

2. Areas for improvement.

☐ N/A If Yes, explain: When practical, TFC Shackleford should give verbal warnings before she deploys her Taser.

3. Other considerations.

☐

N/A

If Yes, explain: At the conclusion of the pursuit, the violator refused officers' commands. TFC Shackleford deployed her issued Taser in order to gain compliance/control of the violator. A Use of Force Report was completed.

RESPONSE FROM TROOPER OR SUPERVISOR

1. Allow trooper and supervisor an opportunity to respond or add comments.

☒

N/A

If Yes, explain:

CORRECTIVE ACTION TAKEN

1. Describe any corrective action taken as a result of the trooper's actions during the pursuit.

☒

N/A

If Yes, explain:

Lt. T. L. Nichols #36
Reviewing Officer

Lt. T. L. Nichols #36

6/28/2024

Date